Fall 2010

The Mountainside

Coolfont Mountainside Association

Volume X Issue 1

Calendar of Events

President's Message

By Jackson Bain

Autumn's New Year

Masters of chronology insist that the New Year begins on January 1, but as the father of five kids (including one period in which they were all teenagers at one time), I consider the day after Labor Day the beginning of the new cycle. School starts, summer vacation is over, new clothes, books, teams to support, carpools to organize and new challenges for our growing up family members—all were in the process of becoming the fine adults they are today. Now our grandchildren begin the cycle anew each Fall.



Jackson, along with Jason Geno, Flo Merola, Myrna Wohl, Bob Borchers and Jean Cohen at a potluck at Jason's home!

Sandy and I always appreciate the Fall because it brings that freshness back to us, that breathless excitement of something new just around the corner. Crisp air, a wild palette of color all around us—and this place—Coolfont, in which we can enjoy it all.

Our CMA Annual Meeting was moved to October a few years ago, and I think it's a great idea—over the following two and a half months, newly elected board members and volunteer committee members have time to learn how the mountainside infrastructure works and prepare themselves to lead in the constant effort to keep our neighborhood amenities reliable. It's a time to re-examine what we must do to protect our investments here, and to bring improvement to the parts of our community that need it.

The water system renewal is continuing, now under the leadership of Joe Van Meter and Rick Picardi, who will

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Ask Not What CMA Can Do For You Ask What You Can Do For CMA

By Arnold Weinberg

These words, with a little editing, are as true today as they were fifty years ago. CMA has always relied on its members volunteering to manage its finances, capital projects, maintenance, recreation, social events and every other activity needed to give homeowners, their guests and renters the Coolfont experience. It's important to note that the CMA staff consists of your neighbors, and we urge you to lend your ideas, your energy and your hands in helping keep your property investment solid and the Coolfont way of life as beautiful and supportive as it is.

The benefits of volunteering are two-fold:

1. Volunteer participation enables us to contract out fewer tasks. This allows us to keep assessments as low as possible

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Calendar of Events

October 23
Annual Meeting
10 AM-Angus & Ale
Adjacent to Best Western on 522

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CMA Annual Dinner-6 PM
Italian Job II Restaurant
87 Washington Street

.....

October 23 & 24
Berkeley Springs
Studio Tour

****

November 13
Board Meeting
10 AM CMA Office
6:30 PM Potluck Dinner
Saleem & Ivy Hylton
R-7 Heaven House

****

December 11
Board Meeting
10 AM CMA Office
6:30 PM Potluck Dinner
Gordon & Mary Kay Cloney
K-6 Dolce Vita

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The New CMA Website

By Bob Borchers

Maybe the third time is the charm, given the comments when we brought up our third web design since I initially volunteered to become the CMA webmaster at the annual meeting in 2002. The reason for the most recent update is an amusing combination of necessity and serendipity.

Our past web site, which is the one most of you remember, was based on web design technology developed at Appalachian State University. In July, when Jackson Bain and I were adding the most recent Mountainside events, we noticed difficulty editing entries. A work-around was found, but the underlying cause were some changes our web hosting provider had made, coupled with the fact that they no longer supported the technology we had been using. Thus the search for a new solution was on.

Serendipity came in mid August. We hosted a birthday party/family reunion for my sister Judy at the Mountainside and I was trying to find the hours for the Thursday Berkeley Springs Farmer's Market, so fresh local goodies could be obtained for the BIG dinner and birthday fest. A trip to Google found that the Farmer's Market has a website http://berkeleyspringsfarmersmarket.org. A visit to the site provided the answer, the hours are 2-5PM until October7. I was impressed by the design and skillful implementation of the Farmer's Market site and discovered that it came from http://thewebwench.com. A visit there allowed me to look at their portfolio of sites, all of which were very impressive. I called Jackson and suggested that we investigate having our new website designed by the same person, who we later found is Christi Stewart-Brown, a resident of Berkeley Springs.

Jackson, not being one to wait around, called her, and within a week we were looking at some design ideas, all of which we liked. The new site went live shortly after that to great reviews. Christi is wonderfully responsive and helpful.

Another element in this picture is that since the listserv went up, the need for semi-private communications with the CMA members can be handled there. That allowed the decision to be made that the new website would be (and is) completely open, i.e. no pass-worded content, which I am sure is a great relief to those of you for whom getting into parts of the old web site was frustrating at best.

The bulk of the content from the old site has been moved to the new one, so CMA documents, Board minutes, etc. are readily available. There are great plans to extend the amount of information available on the new site and your comments are most welcome.

A number of our fellow members helped, i.e. Lois Copeland, Liz Dane, Rosemary Bigelow, and Mary Kay Cloney all contributed ideas, art and inspiration. If you have suggestions or comments, just go to the "contacts page" to send email to either Jackson, or me, or contact any member of the communications committee with your suggestions and ideas.



Picture of the home page of our new website. Click on and see how easy it is.

Ask Not What CMA Can Do For You Ask What You Can Do For CMA

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Lack of volunteers, obviously, has the opposite effect.

2.Homeowners working on community projects develop relationships and a rich and fun social network with their Coolfont neighbors.

A total of about 30 people continue to volunteer when needed. These 30 individuals represent approximately 17 of the 117 homeowners on the Mountainside. You are urged to join in and help.

We are hoping to add to our list of volunteers. All skills are welcome, but there are plenty of us who discovered unknown skills from on-the-job training.

If you are interested in volunteering, please send your name to me at:

marzarn@comast.net.

Arnold Weinberg, H-1



The Unicorn on the Mountainside

By Tom Hess

Sandy and I enjoy a myriad of pleasure when we visit our house on the Mountainside, especially when time and weather permit us to stroll around the area, particularly along Mountainside Road. We've been doing this ever since we built our house some eleven years ago.

Recently, however, an event occurred when we were enjoying the clean, healthy air of rural West Virginia. We came upon what we thought was a tree, a very special tree, but, as we later discovered, there exists grave doubt in our minds if, in fact, it is a tree at all.

If you will look at the photograph that we took recently, you will notice a real, unmistakable **UNICORN.** Now a unicorn is described as a "mythical creature resembling a horse, with a single horn in the center of its forehead; often symbolic of chastity or purity." Being all too aware that neither "chastity" nor "purity" applies to anyone we have ever met on the Mountainside, we searched further and found the following:



Have you spotted our Mountainside Unicorn!

"For true believers, the fact that unicorns no longer exists only adds to the mystique; placing it in the same realm as the dinosaur, the mammoth, and possibly such unknown creatures as Bigfoot and the Loch Ness Monster. Others believe that the Unicorn still exists in remote regions and can be discovered only by those of exceptional virtue and honesty."

We trust there are others who have developed a relationship with the Mountainside Unicorn. Since our original encounter with him (or is it 'her') we have developed a guarded (but increasingly friendly) relationship. In fact, we have begun singing to him and occasionally bringing offerings of food. All we can tell you is that the food is gone the next time we visit.

So we say to all of our friends: **BEWARE!** The Unicorn is on the Mountainside and may be looking to you for companionship or even food or sustenance of any kind. He may have a mate, or he may be looking for one. He could be lonely, and in need of a friend. Whatever the case, he will be there all day, everyday, rain or shine, winter or summer. We hope he is your friend and if you are lucky, he may wink at you as he did to us the last time we visited

President's Message

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keep the project focused on resolving the remaining challenges as we rebuild the water lines in sections D, F, G, and I, with additional meter and line replacement work in other sections as needed. In addition, our new control systems will be designed and installed in the months to come, increasing system reliability and providing early notification of water problems, so repairs can be made expeditiously.

The new year has begun, the air is fresh and expectant, I can't think of a place I'd rather ring it in than on this beautiful mountainside with you, our friends and neighbors.

Best regards,

Jackson



Picture taken by Lois Copland from her deck on K-1

$$$$$

Time is running out. If you do not pick up your House Number before November 1, 2010, it will cost you $50.00 to retrieve it from storage. You may also be subject to a fine if your house number is not posted in a location visible to Emergency Personnel.

We were the first community in West Virginia to be recognized as a Firewise Community. We do not want to lose this recognition.

For pick-up and/or installation call Shane Cheatham at 304-258-2984.

Attention K-Mart Shoppers

By Jason Geno

That blue light you see moving around the Mountainside is not a K-Mart special: it is one part of the Coolfont Security Program (CMASP).

There are usually two patrol circuits of the Mountainside—one during the day and one at night. In order to not establish a predictable schedule the times of these patrols will vary. This, along with Neighborhood Watch, should be a major deterrent to crime. Security patrol procedures will soon be available on the CMA Website.

Currently, we have four homeowners performing these patrols. We could use additional volunteers to do weekday patrols. If you are interested, please contact Jason Geno at:

jegl568@gmail.com



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Sam Ashelman

Sam Ashelman, 97, passed away August 10, 2010. He moved his family to Berkeley Springs in 1960. Sam founded Coolfont Re+Creation soon after. Over the years Coolfont developed into a conference center and a full service spa with health programs.

Under Sam & Martha Ashelman's leadership the Coolfont Foundation sponsored free classical music concerts by renowned musicians. It was at these concerts in the Manor House living room that I developed a real sense of the Coolfont Community and knew this was my special retreat.

We owe our peaceful, mountainside retreat to the vision of Sam Ashelman. As Jackson Bain said, "our mountainside neighborhood still lives his dream, and we are grateful for his imagination and inspiration."



Bits of News

By Lois Copeland

Summer

We had a very successful, as well as hot summer. CMA sponsored three fun pool parties on Memorial Day, July 4, and Labor Day. I found it heartwarming to see so many of our members of such diverse ages enjoying themselves. New pool furniture added to our relaxation.

Our children and grandchildren loved *The Magic Meadow,* in spite of the heat. Our long, cold, snowy winter was a distant memory. Thank you to our Social Chair Hallie Kerr, Pool Chair Bob Cohen and Recreation Chair Jason Geno. Also a big thank you to Larry Merola and Jay Copeland for their grilling skills.



Out and About

Ambrae House Bar and Grill, for-



mally known as the "old Perry House", has been beautifully restored and refurbished. The restaurant gives off a feeling of dining at a country inn. Must try on the menu are the loaded fries, topped with bacon, chili, jack & cheddar cheese and served with ranch dressing.. Of course it's a must share item. Service brunch thru dinner Wednesday-Sunday.

Temptations Café, wonderful food in a casual friendly setting. Tops on the menu is the jumbo lump crab cake with sweet potato fries. Really does taste as good as a Maryland crab cake.

Coming soon, Temptations Too opening right next door to the Café., a bakery, cheese shop and culinary emporium.

Nature Niche, my favorite. I always buy my supplies at the Nature Niche. Need a gift, advice on our outdoor friends, stop in at 50 N. Washington St.

Looking for entertainment, try music at the **Faixfax Coffee House** and **Earth Dog Café**.



Congratulations to Rosemary Bigelow . She was one of eight local businesses to receive a "Certification of Recognition" award from Governor Joe Manchin. She is the owner of My Grandmother's Lace that specializes in an eclectic mix of romantic home furnishings and accessories.

****Remember support your local business****